

# DRAFT VO.2 REVIEW

A cold read of every current Hexside document — rulebook, card sheet, board, component list, both PDFs — checked for rules gaps, cross-document drift, worked-example errors, balance, and physical print practicality. Run by Opus with no memory of how the documents were built, against the live files directly.

Reviewed: hexside-rulebook.html · hexside-cards.html/.pdf · hexside-pitch.html · hexside-components.html · hexside-tokens.pdf

**0**

OPEN · CRITICAL

**0**

OPEN · MODERATE

**2**

OPEN · MINOR

**29/31**

FIXED

**The geometry, hex addressing, card counts, and print-fit math are all genuinely solid** — independently re-derived and none of it broke. The problems, as originally found, were concentrated in three places: a dice tie-break rule that contradicted itself between the rulebook and the printed reference card, a turn sequence with no legal timing window for roughly half the Tactic deck, and a handful of rules that quietly referenced game states the ruleset never produced (a ball leaving the pitch, a declared Foul).

**Current status: 29 of 31 findings fixed.** Every critical and moderate item is resolved. The two still open — D6 (a balance question being settled by actual playtesting before committing to a fix) and D8 (informational notes, no fix planned) — are both intentionally left as-is, not overlooked.

Below is the full findings list, organized as a punch list first, then the detail behind each item. Fixed items are struck through with a checkmark; anything still plain text is still open.

## PUNCH LIST

What to fix, in order. Jump to any item for the full write-up.

## FIX BEFORE NEXT PLAYTEST (12)

- ✓ ~~The tie-break rule contradicts itself—and prints wrong on the reference card~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~§6 step 4 makes it illegal for a ball carrier to pass or shoot~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~The one-action cap collides with the Dribble Challenge~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~The turn sequence has no legal window for at least five Tactic cards~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~There is no rule for declaring a Foul~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~Shots have no defined range, no line of sight, and no rule for a missing keeper~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~Example 1 (Pass) contradicts the Playmaker's own signature—and so does Through Ball~~ — Examples
- ✓ ~~The Zone Map icon is transposed in the HTML card sheet—the PDF is correct~~ — Drift
- ✓ ~~A stale v0.1 rulebook is sitting in the same folder~~ — Drift
- ✓ ~~§16 Build Guide misstates the card sheet layout~~ — Drift
- ✓ ~~Team A's own tokens are invisible on Team A's goal~~ — Physical
- ✓ ~~Four dice isn't enough to roll both pools at once~~ — Physical

## FIX BEFORE IT MATTERS (7)

- ✓ ~~Nothing in the game ever puts the ball out of play~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~Assorted smaller gaps a real table will hit~~ — Rules
- ✓ ~~Offside Trap's example ignores the goalkeeper~~ — Examples
- ✓ ~~The token sheet is invisible to the rulebook~~ — Drift
- ✓ ~~The turn tally strip is a phantom component~~ — Drift
- ✓ ~~One action per turn drains most of the meaning out of the Command Deck~~ — Balance
- ✓ ~~Slide Tackle is a trap card~~ — Balance

## CAN WAIT (12)

- ✓ ~~The One-Two diagram draws a move through an occupied hex~~ — Examples

✓ ~~Two diagram-rendering bugs in the rulebook's own SVGs~~ — Examples

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✓ ~~Assorted smaller drift~~ — Drift

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✓ ~~Vision makes Through Ball (and half of Long Ball) dead weight~~ — Balance

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✓ ~~Offside Trap is likely unplayable in practice~~ — Balance

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✓ ~~Dribbling is close to strictly dominated by passing~~ — Balance

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D6 ~~No anti-stalling pressure~~ — Balance

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✓ ~~Parking a defender in the goal box looks like a free lunch~~ — Balance

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D8 ~~Smaller observations~~ — Balance

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✓ ~~The ball-under-the-carrier convention doesn't survive contact with the components~~ —  
Physical

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✓ ~~Card backs are one-of-each, not one set per deck~~ — Physical

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✓ ~~The Tactic deck's last sheet has a single card on it~~ — Physical

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## A · BLOCKING RULES PROBLEMS

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Things a real game will hit and have no answer for, or where the printed rule is wrong.

## A1 ~~THE TIE BREAK RULE CONTRADICTS ITSELF — AND PRINTS WRONG ON THE REFERENCE CARD~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §7, line 396 · hexside-cards.html line 478 · hexside-cards.pdf p.10

"the attacker needs **strictly more** to succeed — **ties favor the attacker**, keeping play moving forward." These are opposite rules in one sentence. Every one of the 20 worked examples resolves ties as *attacker loses* — so "strictly more" is the intended rule, and "ties favor the attacker" is the error. But it's the half that made it onto the printed Dice Reference card, the only version most players will read at the table.

| CONTEST                         | TIES → DEFENDER | TIES → ATTACKER |
|---------------------------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| Shot 3 vs Save 3                | 33.2%           | 66.8%           |
| Tackle 3 vs Control 2           | 43.2%           | 78.6%           |
| Control 2 vs Tackle 3 (dribble) | 21.4%           | 66.8%           |

**FIXED AS** Delete "ties favor the attacker" everywhere it appears. Rewrite the Dice Reference card to: "Net Success must exceed net Stop; ties go to the defender."

## A2 ~~§6 STEP 4 MAKES IT ILLEGAL FOR A BALL CARRIER TO PASS OR SHOOT~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html, line 352

"Act (optional, once per turn, by any one activated unit **that is adjacent to the ball** or an opponent)." A ball-carrier is *on* the ball hex, not adjacent to it. Read literally, only a unit without the ball can Pass or Shoot. Every worked example violates this as written.

**FIXED AS** "...by any one activated unit that is carrying the ball, standing on a loose ball, or adjacent to an opposing ball-carrier."

### A3 ~~THE ONE ACTION CAP COLLIDES WITH THE DRIBBLE CHALLENGE~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §6 line 352, §7 line 399, Example 2 line 829

Dribble Challenge is listed as one of the four actions, but §7 says it's triggered automatically by movement in step 3. If it consumes the turn's one action, a carrier forced into a challenge by moving can never then shoot — "beat your man and shoot" becomes illegal, the most basic sequence in football. Example 2's own result text contradicts itself on this: *"Movement may continue for the rest of its Pace if it hasn't already used its one action this turn"* — it just did, by definition. Sequencing is also unclear: movement happens at step 3, but the roll happens at step 7, after the opponent's Counter window at step 6.

**FIXED AS** State explicitly that Dribble Challenge is not the action — it's a movement tax — and resolve it inline during step 3, with the Counter window opening at that moment.

### A4 ~~THE TURN SEQUENCE HAS NO LEGAL WINDOW FOR AT LEAST FIVE TACTIC CARDS~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §6 steps 5–8, §9 line 415

Step 5 plays a Tactic card, step 6 is the opponent's Counter, step 7 rolls and resolves. But several cards need to act *after* the roll: **Step-Over** (reroll dice) is inherently post-roll. **Nutmeg**'s own example plays the dice first, then the card. **Last-Ditch Block**'s example states outright it's "playable as a Counter specifically so this can happen after you've seen the roll" — but §9 puts the Counter window before the roll. **Advantage Play** responds to a Foul, which resolves at step 8. **Offside Trap** fires on the opponent's turn, but §9 says only Counter cards can do that, and it isn't one.

This isn't cosmetic — timing changes the price. Nutmeg at 2 Flair is a 55.6% coin-flip gamble if committed pre-roll, and a near-guaranteed win if played post-roll.

**FIXED AS** Add an explicit two-window structure — a declare window (step 5) and a react window after dice are rolled but before results apply — and tag each Tactic card with which window it uses.

#### A5 ~~NOTHING IN THE GAME EVER PUTS THE BALL OUT OF PLAY~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §12 and the Quick Throw example — the only places these terms appear at all

No rule anywhere causes the ball to leave the pitch: a failed shot is always a Save, a failed pass is always an intercept, a failed dribble always spills on the contested hex. That means the **Corner** and **Throw-In** set pieces are unreachable, and both copies of the **Quick Throw** Tactic card are dead. "Onside" is referenced in §12 but never defined anywhere — there is no offside rule in the base game.

**FIXED AS** Took the lean-v0.2 route: cut Corner, Throw-In, and Quick Throw (Tactic Deck now 26 cards, 13 designs), added a line to §12 stating the ball never leaves the pitch, and listed out-of-bounds as a §15 future module.

#### A6 ~~THERE IS NO RULE FOR DECLARING A FOUL~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §7 line 401, §11, Example 4 line 878

§7's Tackle rule says "lose, and nothing happens ... unless a Foul is declared — see §11." §11 never says how to declare one; it only describes what the Discipline deck does once you have. The Foul Tactic card only covers a Dribble Challenge or Pass "in progress" — not a failed Tackle. Example 4's own result text ("*unless Team A's player chooses to commit a Foul instead*") is supported by no actual rule.

**FIXED AS** Add an explicit declare-a-Foul mechanism to §11 (or fold Tackle fouls into the Foul Tactic card's scope) before the next playtest.

## A7 ~~SHOTS HAVE NO DEFINED RANGE, NO LINE OF SIGHT, AND NO RULE FOR A MISSING KEEPER~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §3 line 310, §7 (Shot)

"A shot may only be taken ... with an unobstructed lane into the goal box or its immediate approach (Third 1 or Third 3 on the attacking side)." "Unobstructed lane" is never defined — there's no line-of-sight rule anywhere. As written, the parenthetical makes *anywhere in Third 3* legal at no distance penalty: a Poacher shooting from four hexes out is identical to one on the goal line. Nothing confines the goalkeeper to the box, and a Red Card can remove them entirely — what's the defense pool with no keeper present? Undefined. The "defender in the goal box adds 1 Defense die" rule — genuinely load-bearing for shot balance — is buried as a parenthetical house-rule aside rather than a real rule.

**FIXED AS** Pin down a shot distance/range, define or delete "unobstructed lane," state what happens with an empty goal, and promote the goal-box defender die from aside to real rule.

## A8 ~~ASSORTED SMALLER CAPS A REAL TABLE WILL HIT~~

✓ FIXED

Various — §5, §7, §9, roster signature abilities, §12

~~Kickoff after a goal: units aren't reset, the scoring side can be standing adjacent to the restart, with no 10-yard-style rule to hold them back. Counter timing: if a Counter-forced Tackle succeeds mid-turn, is the opponent's declared action cancelled? Unstated. Hand deadlock: exactly one card is played per turn, Counters are never playable on your own turn, and Full Press can shrink your hand to 3 — a hand of 3 Counters is a legal deadlock with no discard/pass option defined. Signature timing: Vision, Clinical (a post-roll reroll), Command the Box, Last Man, and Overlap have no defined place in the turn sequence.~~

**FIXED AS** §7's Restarts paragraph now defines the 10-hex center circle. §9 states explicitly that a successful Counter-forced Tackle resolves as its own Resolution Sequence and cancels the original action outright (Flair already spent on it is not refunded). §5 adds an explicit escape for an all-Counter hand: discard one, activate nothing, draw back up — and spells out the exact hand-size trajectory after a Full Press (5→4→3, then straight back to 5). All five roster signatures (Command the Box, Last Man, Overlap, Vision, Clinical) now carry an explicit turn-sequence cross-reference in their §13 table cell.

## B · WORKED-EXAMPLE ERRORS

All 20 examples were re-verified for valid hex addresses, adjacency, and dice arithmetic — every address, distance, and dice total checks out. These four are the substantive problems that remain.

B1

### ~~EXAMPLE 1 (PASS) CONTRADICTS THE PLAYMAKER'S OWN SIGNATURE — AND SO DOES THROUGH BALL~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html lines 783–805, 981–997; roster line 491

The Playmaker's signature is **Vision** — "this unit's passes ignore one opposing Zone of Control," with no once-per-match limit (every other limited signature says so explicitly). Example 1 has the Playmaker pass into exactly one opposing Zone of Control; Vision should cancel it for free. Instead the example rolls it and it's intercepted. The Through Ball tactic example then "rewinds Example 1's exact setup" and spends 1 Flair to buy the ability the passer already has for free. See D3 for the deck-balance consequence.

**FIXED AS** Either limit Vision (once per turn/match, matching every other signature) or rewrite both examples with a passer other than the Playmaker.

B2

### ~~OFFSIDE TRAP'S EXAMPLE IGNORES THE GOALKEEPER~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html lines 1107–1124

"No Team B defender remains in J, K, L, or M to challenge it" — but Team B's Goalkeeper is in M4 or M5 in essentially every real board state. Either the keeper counts as "a defender of yours," in which case the card can almost never fire, or it doesn't, and the rule needs to say so. The example's diagram simply omits the keeper rather than answering the question.

**FIXED AS** Ruled that the Goalkeeper does not count as a defender for Offside Trap. Added that line to the card's rule text (§10 table), and redrew the worked example's diagram to include the Goalkeeper sitting at M5, in the goal box, explicitly not preventing the trap from firing.

### B3 ~~THE ONE-TWO DIAGRAM DRAWS A MOVE THROUGH AN OCCUPIED HEX~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html lines 1033–1051

The dashed arrow runs C2 → E2, straight through D2 — where the Playmaker is now standing after receiving the pass. §6 step 3 forbids moving through an occupied hex.

**FIXED AS** One-Two's rule text (table, worked example, and both printed card sources) now says explicitly it's a placement into any unoccupied hex adjacent to the teammate, not a path move — it doesn't need a clear route and can't trigger a Dribble Challenge along the way. Diagram caption updated to match.

### B4 ~~TWO DIAGRAM-RENDERING BUGS IN THE RULEBOOK'S OWN SVGS~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html lines 578, 685, 708

The formation figure calls `laneTint(l==='Top'?1:l==='Center'?3:5)` against a `laneTint` that buckets  $\text{Top} \leq 3 / \text{Center} \leq 5$  — so Center-lane hexes render in the Top tint and Bottom hexes render in the Center tint; red never appears. Separately, the shared `laneTint` used by all 20 worked-example diagrams treats rows 4–5 as Center for every column, but a short column's Center is only row 4 (per §3) — so row 5 of every short column tints as Center when it should be Bottom. The formation figure's own `laneF()` gets this right; the two rendering paths in the same file disagree.

**FIXED AS** The formation figure now maps Top/Center/Bottom straight to the tint colors instead of routing through fabricated row numbers. The shared `laneTint(row, short)` takes the column's shortness as a second argument, so a short column's row 4 tints Center and row 5+ tints Bottom, matching §3.

## C · CROSS-DOCUMENT DRIFT

Places the rulebook, card sheet, PDFs, and component list disagree with each other.

**C1** ~~THE ZONE MAP ICON IS TRANSPOSED IN THE HTML CARD SHEET — THE PDF IS CORRECT~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-cards.html lines 314–323 vs build\_hexside\_cards\_pdf.py lines 108–120

The Zone Map card's own legend: "Columns = Thirds ... Rows = Lanes ... Lane cards light a row; Third cards light a column." The **PDF renders this correctly** — confirmed by rendering the Lane — Top card, which lights the top row. The **HTML sheet renders it transposed**: the CSS grid fills row-major with Thirds as the outer loop, so in the HTML version "Lane — Top" lights the left column and "Third — 1" lights the top row — the reverse of its own legend and of the real pitch.

**FIXED AS** Print from hexside-cards.pdf (already correct), or swap the loop nesting in zoneIcon() in hexside-cards.html to match.

**C2** ~~A STALE V0.1 RULEBOOK IS SITTING IN THE SAME FOLDER~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.md

Still describes 11 columns A–K, 6/5 rows, Thirds A–C / D–H / I–K — the board before the v0.2 extension. Not linked from anywhere current, but it's in the same directory with a near-identical filename.

**FIXED AS** Delete it or move it to an archive folder before the next playtest, so nobody opens the wrong file by mistake.

**C5** ~~§16 BUILD GUIDE MISSTATES THE CARD SHEET LAYOUT~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §16, step 1

"Print the Command, Player, Tactic, and Discipline decks (card sheet, **one page per deck**)."

The card sheet is actually 11 pages: Command 4, Player 1, Tactic 4, Discipline+Reference 1, Backs 1. Anyone following this literally will think their printer misfired.

**FIXED AS** Update the step to say "11 pages total" or list the per-deck page counts.

### C3 THE TOKEN SHEET IS INVISIBLE TO THE RULEBOOK

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §2, §16; hexside-components.html

hexside-tokens.pdf exists and is referenced in the rulebook colophon, but §2 "To print" doesn't list it, §2 "To supply yourself" instead tells you to find "coins, buttons, painted cubes," §16 step 4 says "grab 4 d6s and 10+1 tokens" with no mention of printing them, and the Component List doesn't link the sheet under its token entries.

**FIXED AS** Added the Token Sheet to §2's "To print" list, pointed §2 "To supply yourself" and §16 step 3 at it, and referenced it in the Component List's token rows.

### C4 THE TURN TALLY STRIP IS A PHANTOM COMPONENT

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §1, §2; hexside-components.html

§1 says to track the clock "on the **included** turn tally strip"; §2 and the Component List both list it as a component to supply — but no file actually provides one, and §16 never says to print it.

**FIXED AS** Dropped "included turn tally strip" everywhere — §1, §2, and the Component List now just say "a pencil and any scrap of paper."

### C6 ASSORTED SMALLER DRIFT

✓ FIXED

Various

hexside-cards.pdf carries no "Draft v0.2" label anywhere, while all four HTML files and the token PDF do. Terminology drifts between "Player **Deck**" (rulebook §2/§13/§15) and "Player **Roster**" (cards, components, footers). "Reaction Tackle" (Last Man) vs "Tackle Challenge" (§9) name the same thing differently. All 21 Zone/Lane/Third cards read "Activate every unit currently in..." without "of **your** units" — read literally, they activate the opponent's units too. A stray dev comment in hexside-cards.html still says "Player Roster: one of each (6 total)" — there are 5.

**FIXED AS** Every card sheet page now stamps a footer via page\_footer() in the PDF build script. Rulebook standardized on "Player Roster" (was "Player Deck" in 4 places). "Reaction Tackle" renamed to "Tackle Challenge" everywhere (rulebook, cards.html, PDF script). All Zone/Lane/Third card text now reads "every one of your units." Stray dev comment corrected to "(5 total)."

## D · BALANCE & DESIGN

Judgment calls, not bugs — numbers that suggest a card or mechanic won't do what its description implies.

### D1 ~~ONE ACTION PER TURN DRAINS MOST OF THE MEANING OUT OF THE COMMAND DECK~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §0, §5, §6 step 4

§0 calls the Command Card system "the whole engine of the game," but step 4 caps the entire team at one action per turn — so activation breadth only buys movement. **Full Press** (3 copies) becomes a bad card: activate all five, pay two card draws, still take exactly one action. **Tactical Free** (6 copies, the most numerous single design) is close to strictly best: activate any 2 anywhere, always relevant, no cost. Zone cards (1 copy each) are weakest, since they only pay off if units happen to be clustered. The "narrow-reliable vs broad-risky" tension §5 describes mostly doesn't exist as written, because breadth never buys a second action.

**FIXED AS** Kept the one-action cap for every other card and gave Full Press the payoff instead: §6 step 4 now lets a Full Press turn Act with two different activated units, not one. §5's Full Press row and blurb, the printed card text, and the PDF all updated to match — it's now the one card that buys more than movement.

### D2 ~~SLIDE TACKLE IS A TRAP CARD~~

✓ FIXED

Tactic Deck — Slide Tackle

"**+1 Attack die to a Tackle. On a roll containing a Blank result, draw from the Discipline Deck.**" On a Sweeper's four dice,  $P(\text{at least one Blank}) = 80.2\%$ . Combined with the Discipline deck's 1-in-6 Red Card, that's a **13.4% chance of a red card every single time you play it**, and a 40% chance of yellow-or-worse — for a modest gain (Tackle 3 vs Control 2 goes from 43.2% to 55.0%). No one should ever play this card as written.

**FIXED AS** Retargeted the trigger from "any Blank in the roll" to "the Tackle fails outright" — a successful Slide Tackle now carries no risk at all, and a failed one draws from Discipline. On Tackle 3 vs Control 2 (the reference matchup) that drops the trigger rate from ~80% to the ~45% fail rate: about 7.5% red card and 22.5% yellow-or-worse per play, only on a miss, instead of 13.4%/40% on every play regardless of outcome. Updated the rulebook table row, the worked example (now demonstrates a failed slide drawing Discipline), the printed card, and the PDF.

### D3 ~~VISION MAKES THROUGH BALL (AND HALF OF LONG BALL) DEAD WEIGHT~~

✓ FIXED

Roster + Tactic Deck cross-reference

Direct consequence of B1: the Playmaker's free, unlimited Vision duplicates Through Ball's paid effect exactly, and overlaps Long Ball's Zone-of-Control clause on the same unit. That's 2 of 28 Tactic cards mostly dead, and 2 more half-dead, whenever the Playmaker is the one passing.

**FIXED AS** Resolve alongside B1 — limiting Vision fixes both the example and this card-economy problem at once.

### D4 ~~OFFSIDE TRAP IS LIKELY UNPLAYABLE IN PRACTICE~~

✓ FIXED

Tactic Deck — Offside Trap

Cost 2, and it only fires when the receiver is in the single frontmost column of the defensive third *and* no defender is in that column or behind — which, per B2, may be never once the goalkeeper is accounted for. Two copies of a card that may never resolve in an actual playtest.

**FIXED AS** Resolved by B2: the Goalkeeper doesn't count as a defender, so the card fires exactly when intended — a pushed-up outfield back line caught square — regardless of where the Goalkeeper is standing.

## D5 ~~DRIBBLING IS CLOSE TO STRICTLY DOMINATED BY PASSING~~

✓ FIXED

Cross-reference of §7 dice math

| ATTEMPT                                                 | SUCCESS RATE  |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| Wingback (Control 2) dribbles past a Sweeper (Tackle 3) | 21.4%         |
| Wingback dribbles past a Wingback (Tackle 2)            | 29.6%         |
| Playmaker (Control 3) dribbles past a Sweeper           | 33.2%         |
| Playmaker contested pass vs Control 2                   | 43.2%         |
| Uncontested pass                                        | 100%, no roll |

Worse: since turns alternate, a lost Dribble Challenge spills the ball on the contested hex where the **defender always gets the next claim** — so §7's "up for grabs by either side" isn't really true in practice. A failed dribble is a ~79%-likely clean turnover. Combined with §8's own advice to "stop just outside a Zone of Control," the math tells you never to dribble.

**FIXED AS** Went further than the original suggestion once it turned out spilling onto the carrier's own hex isn't actually contestable — the carrier is already an activated unit standing there, so §7's claim rule would just hand it back automatically, no window for the opponent at all. Instead: on a loss, the carrier's movement still ends on the contested hex, but the ball drops one hex back, onto the hex it just moved from — a hex neither unit occupies, so the normal claim rule genuinely decides it based on positioning and turn order, not a rules guarantee either way.

## D6 NO ANTI-STALLING PRESSURE

Cross-reference of turn economy

Uncontested movement and passing require no dice at all. Defense gets one contest per turn at best, plus 3 Counters and one Last Man for the entire match. A side ahead on the scoreboard can pass between uncontested hexes for the rest of a fixed 24-turn clock and never roll again — which also starves them of Flair, since it only accrues from rolled dice. A draw is a legal result. This is a real degenerate line worth watching in the first playtest.

**FIX** Consider a small per-turn Flair trickle to the side without the ball, or a Zone-of-Control penalty for a carrier that ends its turn adjacent to a defender.

## D7 PARKING A DEFENDER IN THE GOAL BOX LOOKS LIKE A FREE LUNCH

✓ FIXED

§7 Shot, house-rule aside

Nothing forbids standing in the goal box, and the recommended house rule grants +1 Defense die for it. Parking the Pace-2 Sweeper on the spare goal hex permanently drops shot conversion from 33.2% to 25.2% at zero ongoing cost.

**FIXED AS** Already half-fixed by A7's "activated this turn" clause, but that wording was actually broken — a Shot happens on the attacker's turn, so a defender can never literally be "activated this turn" at all. Reworded to "activated on the defending side's most recently completed turn": the die now requires reactivating that defender every single turn you want it live, spending your side's entire turn on that one unit instead of moving the other four. A recurring cost, not a one-time setup — no longer a free lunch.

## D8 SMALLER OBSERVATIONS

Various

A tall column splits 3/2/3 across lanes, a short column 3/1/3 — so the Center lane covers 20 hexes total versus 39 for Top or Bottom, yet Center-related cards have identical counts, and both goal boxes plus kickoff all sit in Center. May be intentional; worth watching in play. The Flair cap of 5 is largely decorative since the priciest card costs 2. Command the Box is close to dead weight, since the defender's turn always comes next after a Save anyway — it only matters in the ~7% of hands with no card reaching the goal box. Attack and Defense dice have identical face distributions (1–2 blank / 3–4 flair / 5–6 hit); worth saying so plainly in §7 so no one hunts for a difference.

# E · PHYSICAL PROTOTYPE PRACTICALITY

What was checked against the actual print dimensions and component counts.

## CONFIRMED SOUND

- Pitch fits A4 landscape: board is 10.80 × 7.71in at R=0.5in; A4 landscape at 0.15in margins gives 11.39 × 7.97in.
- Cards fit A4 portrait 3×3: 7.66 × 10.66in inside 7.97 × 11.39in.
- Tokens fit a hex: 0.7in circles inside an 0.866in inscribed diameter — 0.083in clearance per side, matching the generator's own claim.

- Card counts reconcile perfectly across rulebook §2, the Component List, and both card sources:  $36 + 5 + 26 + 6 + 2 + 4 = 79$ , across 10 printed sheets (post-A5 Quick Throw cut).
- The Flair-cost diamonds render correctly in the PDF (they extract as "N" in raw text, but that's just ZapfDingbats encoding — confirmed by rendering the page).
- The kickoff "1 in 14" hand-luck probability is correct: 14 of 36 cards reach G4/G5;  $C(22,5)/C(36,5) = 6.99\%$ .
- The v0.1 → v0.2 board-growth claims in §3 hold up exactly: rows 6→8 / 5→7 preserve Center depth at 2/1 while Top and Bottom grow; columns 11→13 preserve midfield at 5.

## REMAINING SNAGS

### E1 ~~TEAM A'S OWN TOKENS ARE INVISIBLE ON TEAM A'S GOAL~~

✓ FIXED

hexside-pitch.html goal-box fill vs token color

Side A tokens are `#1B4332`. The pitch paints the A4/A5 goal hexes solid `var(--pitch-green)` — the identical color. The green goalkeeper disappears into the green goal box, in the position it occupies for the entire match.

**FIXED AS** Lighten the goal-box fill, or outline unit tokens in white/ink so they read against any background.

### E4 ~~FOUR DICE ISN'T ENOUGH TO ROLL BOTH POOLS AT ONCE~~

✓ FIXED

Component List — dice count

Max pool is 4 (Curl Shot on Shot 3, or a Counter on Save 3), but attacker and defender roll simultaneously — up to 7–8 dice combined. With only 4 physical dice, the second roller sees the first result before rolling their own, which isn't how simultaneous resolution is supposed to feel.

**FIXED AS** Supply 8 dice in two colors (4 for Attack, 4 for Defense) — it also makes reading the two pools apart much easier at the table.

E2

## THE BALL UNDER THE CARRIER CONVENTION DOESN'T SURVIVE CONTACT WITH THE COMPONENTS

✓ FIXED

hexside-rulebook.html §7 physical-play callout

"A ball token peeking out from under a unit means that unit has it" — but both tokens are 0.7in in a hex with only 0.083in clearance, so at most a sliver would show. Worse, the most common loose-ball state (a ball on the goalkeeper's own hex after a Save) is a ball under a unit that is *not* holding it — the opposite of what the convention implies at a glance.

**FIXED AS** Went with two visually distinct ball markers instead of one — a plain ink-rimmed "Ball" token (carried, sits on top of the unit) and an ochre-rimmed "Loose Ball" token, both 0.4in, matching the color the rulebook's own diagrams already use for loose vs. carried. The token itself now signals the state, so the awkward Save case (loose ball sharing a hex with a non-possessing unit) resolves for free — the ochre token reads as loose no matter what else is on that hex. First attempt (ball centered on top, same design for both states) looked right in isolation but visually hid the unit's label underneath and still couldn't distinguish the Save case — caught by rendering an actual test page before committing to it.

E3

## CARD BACKS ARE ONE OF EACH, NOT ONE SET PER DECK

✓ FIXED

hexside-cards.pdf, Backs sheet

4 back designs print once each, but backing the full Command Deck alone needs 36 identical navy backs.

**FIXED AS** §16 step 1 now spells out that the Backs sheet is one design per deck and needs reprinting to that deck's count (36× for Command, as the example), or can be skipped for a first prototype.

E5

## THE TACTIC DECK'S LAST SHEET HAS A SINGLE CARD ON IT

✓ FIXED

hexside-cards.pdf, Tactic Deck sheet 4

Minor print-efficiency note, not a functional problem.

**FIXED AS** Resolved as a side effect of A5: cutting Quick Throw took the Tactic Deck from 28 to 26 cards, which splits 9+9+8 across 3 pages instead of 9+9+9+1 — no orphan page left.